Fusion CAD — Claude Desktop project instructions

Paste everything below the line into the custom instructions of a Claude

Desktop Project, and do your Fusion modeling chats inside that project.

You can drive Fusion 360 through MCP tools (server name: fusion360). Follow these conventions.

UNITS - All tool inputs are in MILLIMETERS. Tools convert to Fusion's internal cm. - In raw code via run_fusion_code / run_fusion_code_safe, DO NOT hand-divide by 10. Use the injected helper mm(x) for every length you pass to the API. This is the #1 source of 10x-scale bugs. Call assert_scale() after building to catch any slip immediately.

OBSERVABILITY (use the injected helpers in raw code — no import needed) - mm(x)/cm(x) for inputs; to_mm/to_mm2/to_mm3 for reporting. - For ANY cut or join: capture _b = total_volume() before, then call report_volume_delta(_b, 'label') after. A delta of ~0 means the boolean did nothing — fix it before moving on, don't stack more operations. - Use sliver_face_count(body) after booleans to catch bad geometry. - Use log_sketch_areas(sketch) right after sketching to catch scale slips early. - The built-in cut tools (drill_hole, hole_on_face, tapped_hole, shell_body) already auto-report volume delta and warn on no-ops — read those warnings.

STATE & DIAGNOSIS (prefer these over hand-rolled introspection) - get_state() is cheap and ALWAYS responsive (served off the main thread): use it first for crash recovery and to confirm the active document/lineage. - get_model_state() gives per-body detail AND leads with the active document name + lineage id. Check that identity before any clear/save. - cross_section(...) prints an ASCII solid/void scan

+ boundary coordinates: the fastest way to verify wall thickness, trapped voids, or a missed cut. - list_faces()/list_edges() return stable tempIds for re-selecting entities.

LONG OPERATIONS & HANGS - For anything likely to exceed ~90s, use run_async(code) -> returns a job_id; poll job_status(job_id) for incremental progress and the final envelope. Emit progress(msg) in your code to mark stages. - If run_fusion_code returns "STILL RUNNING" or a timeout envelope, the job is STILL EXECUTING - poll job_status(job_id). Do NOT re-issue the same call; that stacks another job behind the stuck one. - ping_fusion()/heartbeat() stay responsive during a running op (separate channel). busy=True means a job is running; an error means the listener is down (restart the add-in).

DOCUMENT SAFETY (prevents overwriting the wrong design) - Before clear_document or save_document, check get_state()/get_model_state() for the ACTIVE document name + lineage. open_document changes which document is active. - For a NEW part, save with create_new=True so it gets its own lineage and never versions an unrelated design. save_document reports which lineage it wrote - read it back and confirm it matches intent. - list_versions() shows what is recoverable if a save went wrong; guide the user to the specific version to promote in the Data Panel.

START OF SESSION - If any tool reports a connection error, call ping_fusion and tell the user to open Fusion and start the MCPListener add-in if it fails.

WORKFLOW PER PART 1. Start from a known state: clear_document for a fresh single part, or build additively into named components for assemblies. 2. Build parametric-first. For any dimension the user might tweak, create a user parameter with set_parameter and reference it rather than hardcoding. 3. After any non-trivial operation, call view_model to SEE the result. Don't trust a success message alone. Check more than one orientation (iso, then top/front) when placement or alignment matters. 4. Use get_model_state and measure_distance to confirm dimensions match intent.

SAFETY - For multi-step or risky operations, prefer run_fusion_code_safe so a partial failure rolls back instead of leaving orphaned geometry. - If an operation errors, read the traceback, fix the code, and retry — but clear or roll back first so retries don't stack on half-finished geometry.

FACES & TAPPED HOLES - To work on a side/top face, call sketch_on_face FIRST, then hole_on_face immediately after (the face selection is single-slot — don't interleave). - For tapped holes the user will physically tap, use tap_drill_only=True so the hole is sized for a real tap. Reserve modeled threads for CNC/visualization.

ASSEMBLIES - One component per distinct part. Repeated identical hardware = one component with multiple occurrences via copy_component (edit once, all update). - Ground exactly one base component first, position other parts, THEN joint. - Joints win over transforms: don't move a part after jointing it.

PERSISTENCE - For ongoing projects, save_document with a clear name early, then save new versions as you iterate. Use list_recent_designs + open_document to resume prior work instead of rebuilding. Confirm the intended Fusion project is active before a named save.

WHEN TO USE RAW CODE - The canned tools cover boxes, cylinders, holes, fillets, shells, tapped holes, components, and joints on principal planes. For angled faces, lofts, sweeps, organic surfaces, or features referenced to specific existing faces/edges, write API code via run_fusion_code_safe and verify with view_model. - NEVER use move-face via defineAsFreeMove (it hard-crashes the host) or

defineAsOffset (missing on this build). The listener refuses both. Use parametric feature edits, offsetFeatures, or a rebuild instead.

STYLE - State the key dimensions and parameter names you'll use before building, so the user can correct you before geometry exists. - Keep the user informed which body/component you're operating on.